



5 THINGS WE LOVED AND 3 THINGS WE DIDN'T

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When the promotions for Deathloop kicked in I was intrigued, but slightly sceptical. I was sceptical about its rogue-lite structure of reliving the same day over and over again. While we have experienced this 'live, die, repeat' formula in Returnal, the way it is executed in Deathloop is a lot more like the movie Edge of Tomorrow than a rogue-lite game. Just like Tom Cruise learns the patterns of the 'Mimics' by reliving each day, you do the same by reliving the same day and learning the enemy patterns and movements to get one step closer to taking out the Visionaries. But there is a catch to this formula which we will describe below.

Before we get to what we loved and didn't like about Deathloop, here's answering the all-important question - is Deathloop for you? Well, if you are a fan of fast-paced FPS games like Doom Eternal, Call of Duty, etc. then Deathloop may disappoint you. Unlike Doom which is more about running and gunning, Deathloop is about strategizing, planning and then executing. If you enjoyed games like Dishonored, or Thief or even Bioshock to

some extent, then you are in for one heck of a ride.

Well woven story with a good mystery

From the moment your character, Colt, wakes up on the beach, you are in for one heck of a story filled with some of the best-written dialogue I've heard in a video game and some impeccable voice acting to compliment it. How many times can you hear a man talk about reading text on the wall and chuckle at his description and analysis of what he has read? This has happened on multiple occasions in the game and I looked forward to every time Colt opened his mouth as I was sure there'd be a wise-cracking one-liner coming my way.

This form of storytelling is only accentuated and complemented because of the relationship between Colt and the other Visionaries (the main villains you need to eliminate), especially Juliana. Without spoiling too much, the relationship between the 2 is explored a lot in the game and their banter is one to look out for.

Colt shares a relationship with the other Visionaries as well, but the details are hidden in text conversations on

computers and documents scattered throughout the game. I wish there was more dialogue between Colt and the Visionaries. I just feel like I have missed some grand detail by not reading all the documents thoroughly. The story of Deathloop is one of its strongest suits.

Slick combat

The combat in Deathloop is easy to learn and can be mastered if you spend a little time learning the ropes. You cannot carry any weapons or abilities back with you in a loop until you unlock Residium which is like the currency you use to attach gear, guns and abilities to yourself permanently. The combat is an evolution of what we found in Dishonored. Powers from Dishonored such as Shift (the ability to quickly move/jump to places) and Nexus (the ability to link multiple foes and kill them with a single shot) make an appearance here as well. There are other powers as well such as Aether that makes you invisible for some time, Havoc which increases your damage and defensive abilities, Karnesis which lets you hurl enemies into the air and more. The ability unique to Colt is Reprise which essentially gives you 3 lives before resetting the day again.